

“Choose Your Own Adventure” Independent Mapping Proposal and Project

GEO 429R: Summer Field Geology, Summer 2020

In this assignment you will develop and complete a geology mapping project. The focus of this mapping project is entirely up to you. However, it should relate in some way to coursework you have completed as part of your degree in Earth Sciences at Montana State University. Your project can be conducted remotely (online with the help of remote sensing or other data) or in the field. In the latter scenario, students assume all responsibility for ensuring safety in every stage of the project. As field work is entirely voluntary, all risks are assumed by the participant. You are responsible for complying with all rules and regulations pertaining to the study area at the time the activity is conducted.

Part 1: The proposal

Students will submit a formal proposal to the assignment submission folder by Wednesday, June 3 at 5 PM MDT. The proposal must include the following:

1. Summary of the mapping project.
2. Location of the field area/area of interest. Field area must be on public land if planning to conduct field work.
3. Hypothesis to be tested.
4. Type of data to be collected.
5. Method of data collection.
6. List of required field and safety equipment.
7. Summary of the expected deliverables and their format. Specify the type of map to be created (physical, dynamic, hand-drawn, etc...).
8. If your project involves any field work, you must read the Montana State University Geological Field Work Safety Guide, sign and return the Acknowledgement of Participant (page 17), complete and return the Field Research

Part 2: Submission of final project

Submit your completed mapping project along with any accompanying documentation to the assignment submission folder by Sunday, June 14 at 5 PM MDT.

Example project ideas

Detailed (1:12,000) geological map of the High Ore trail at Copper City.

Map of landslide deposits at Pete’s Hill, Bozeman, MT.

Quaternary geologic map of the field near my house.

Map of paleo-shorelines.

Map of joints in the granite pluton along my favorite hiking trail.

Occurrence of theropod fossils in the Hell Creek Formation.

Lineaments in Big Sky, MT Lidar data from OpenTopography